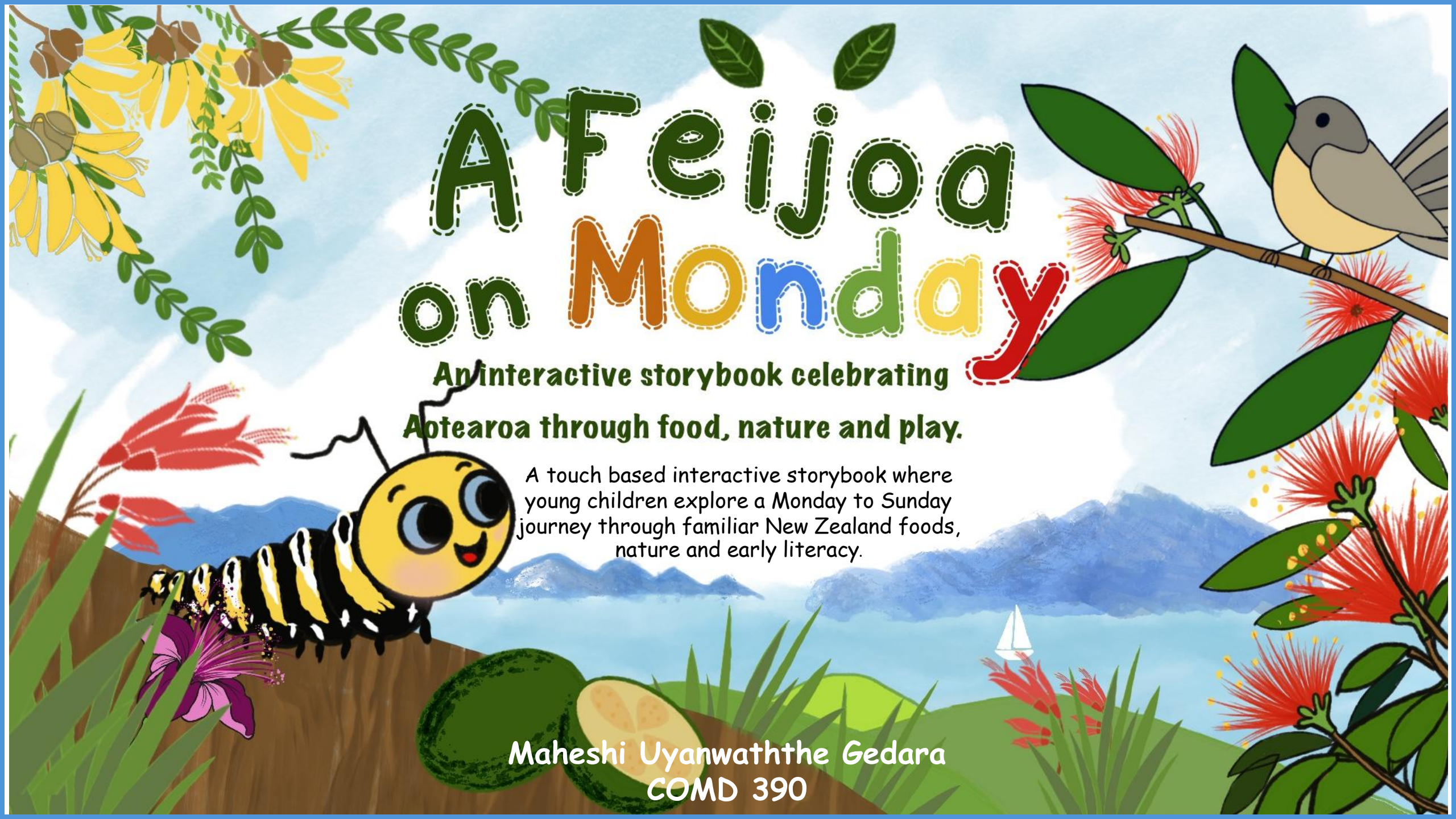




A Feijoa on Monday

**An interactive storybook celebrating
Aotearoa through food, nature and play.**

A touch based interactive storybook where
young children explore a Monday to Sunday
journey through familiar New Zealand foods,
nature and early literacy.

**Maheshi Uyanwaththe Gedara
COMD 390**



Why I made it



The Problem:

Many children's stories use environments, foods and experiences that don't necessarily reflect children's everyday lives in Aotearoa.

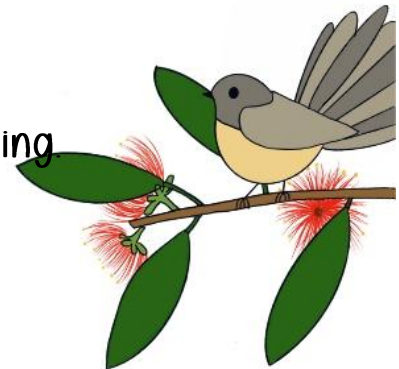
My Goal:

I want to make an interactive story for New Zealand children, based on one of their favourite classic stories. I am changing it to include New Zealand foods, plants, and nature, so children can see their own world in the story. Through this project, I want to:

- Give NZ children a story that shows their own world
- Add touch interaction with audio to make the story fun and easy to use.
- Include early literacy and counting to help children learn while they enjoy the story
- Make a real, professional product, using tools used in the design industry

What I want to achieve:

Personally, I want to learn how design can help young children connect with stories, culture and learning



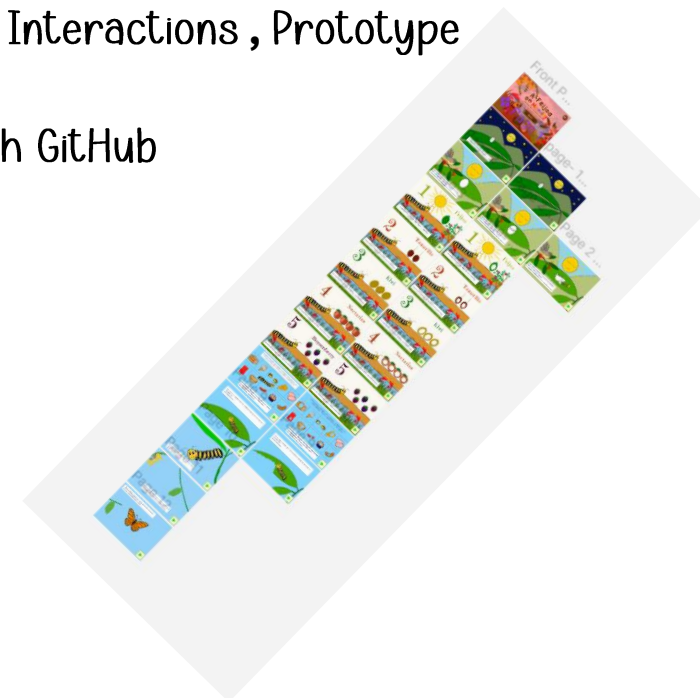
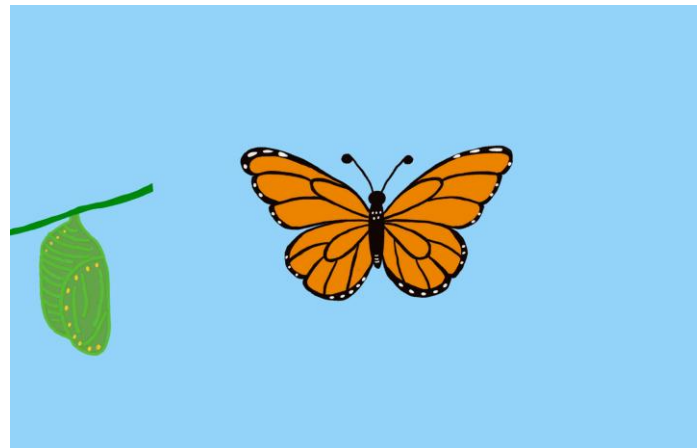
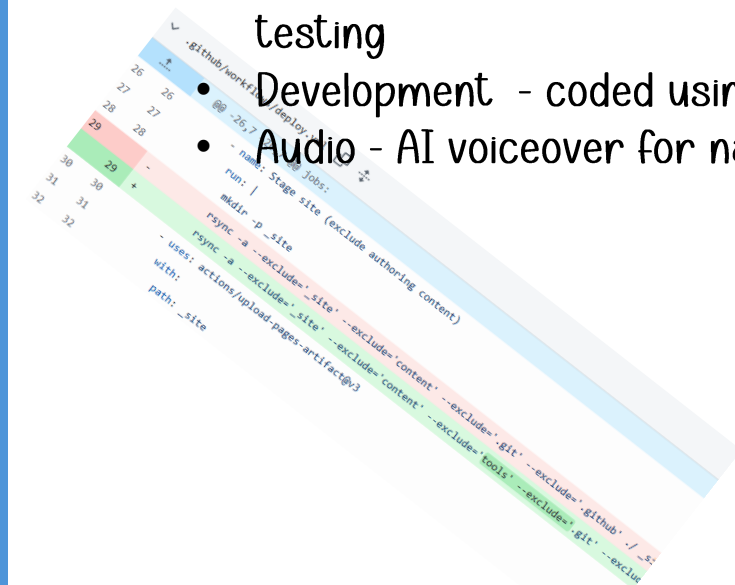
Production and how I made it

Format:

An interactive digital storybook for children aged 3–8 , in a tap-along format. Built as a live , working website so it can be properly tested on real devices.

Production pipeline:

- Illustration - Procreate (all illustrations hand drawn digitally)
- Interaction Design –Figma - Screen layouts , Page structure , Story flow , Buttons , Interactions , Prototype testing
- Development - coded using HTML/JavaScript and published as a live website through GitHub
- Audio - AI voiceover for narration on each





Audience and publishing



Audience:

Primary audience: young children in Aotearoa approximately ages 3-8. Secondary audience: parents , whānau , ECE teachers , libraries and who share stories with young children.

Comparable projects:

- The Very Hungry Caterpillar - A well-loved , simple story with counting. which this project reimagines
- Hairy Maclary - A strong example of local NZ identity in children's stories
- Nosy Crow - Known for meaningful, well-designed interactivity for children

Published at:

<https://maheshistudy.github.io/a-feijoa-on-monday/>

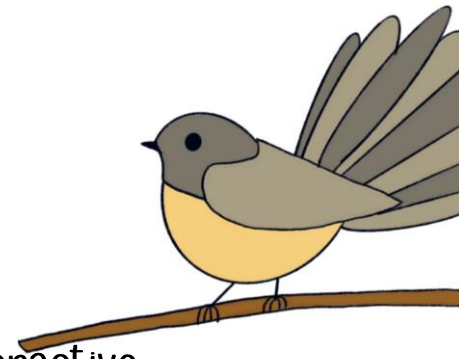
Live now

Hope outcome:

- Give NZ children a story that feels familiar to their own world
- Show that a local story can be as engaging as well known children's apps
- Support early cognitive development through game based learning (Bishop. 1990)
- Build a strong portfolio piece that opens doors for future work in children's design



Why this project? why now?



A Feijoa on Monday brings together my interests in children's books , illustration , animation and interactive design. All skills I've built throughout my Communication Design and Animation degree.

I wanted to create a story that introduces young children to familiar New Zealand foods , nature and wildlife through playful interaction.

It's also an ambitious project for me. Since it pushes me beyond illustration and animation into coding and building a real, working interactive product combining everything I've learned into one complete piece of work.

This is the right project at the right time. A chance to bring my whole skill set together in one place, and to test what my practice could look like beyond university. It gives me a strong starting point for developing my career in children's illustration , animation , and interactive storytelling. Also gives me a starting point for developing my practice beyond university. Particularly in children's illustration , animation and interactive storytelling.

